

Meeting Name:	Overview and Scrutiny Committee
Date:	20 January 2026
Report title:	Delivering Southwark 2030 – Council Delivery Plan and Q2 2025/26 Performance update
Ward(s) or groups affected:	All
Classification:	Open
Reason for lateness (if applicable):	N/A
From:	Assistant Chief Executive, Strategy and Communities

RECOMMENDATION(S)

- Overview and Scrutiny Committee are asked to:
 - Note our Delivery Plan performance and progress at Q2 2025/26, and how this will support our continued focus on delivering against our residents' priority areas for action over the next year.
 - Note the progress made in terms of development of Corporate Performance Reporting products, as part of the developing Performance Framework, and how they will support the delivery of the Delivery Plan and key strategic objectives.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

- The Creating Good Lives Together: Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan for 2025/26 was agreed at Cabinet in February 2025, following on from the agreement of the Southwark 2030 Strategy at Council Assembly in November 2024.
- This delivery plan builds on our previous Fairer, Greener, Safer Delivery Plan (2022 – 26), which was adopted by Cabinet in September 2022.
- The report on performance and progress against the Council Delivery Plan is produced each quarter, providing updates against each commitment and associated performance metrics.

KEY ISSUES FOR CONSIDERATION

- The Creating Good Lives Together: Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan creates a clear framework for how we will build the foundations over the next year towards delivering our Southwark 2030 vision.
- The Delivery Plan is structured around the six Southwark 2030 strategy goals and an internal-facing council goal. The commitments in the Delivery Plan outline the priorities and objectives in working towards these goals, representing our major commitments to the people of Southwark for the next year:

- Decent homes for all

2. A good start in life
3. A safer Southwark
4. A strong and fair economy
5. Staying well
6. A healthy environment
7. A well-run council

7. The majority of commitments within this Delivery Plan are a continuation or evolution of our previous plan. They focus our action and effort on the areas where we will need to go further to deliver on our shared ambition for residents.
8. The Delivery Plan also emphasises the importance of our Southwark 2030 guiding principles in how we deliver for residents:
 - Reducing inequality
 - Empowering people
 - Investing in prevention

Council Delivery Plan performance

9. As at the end of Q2, 87 of the 115 Council Delivery Plan commitments are either delivered or on track for delivery by the end of the plan period, representing 76% of commitments. Commitment 7 is split into two parts due to joint service delivery.

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
115*	77	27	2	10

*One commitment split across 2 service areas

- 10 commitments have already been delivered, including successful projects, policy changes and service improvements.
- 77 are on track: These are commitments currently on track for completion by the end of the political term.
- 27 are in progress towards delivery but have experienced challenges or delays.
- 2 are at risk and are not progressing at the expected pace. There is a risk that the commitment will not be delivered by the end of the political term

10. Notable achievements and ongoing areas of focus are as follows:

11. **Goal 1 - Decent homes for all: People live in safe, well-maintained homes**

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
21	10	10	1	0

Areas of progress:

- As at Q2 2025/26, 2172 new council homes have been completed through our council homebuilding programme, with a further 353 currently onsite due for completion prior to March 2026, ensuring we remain on track for 2500 new council home completions.
- The Good Landlord Plan was approved by Cabinet in July 2025. At the end of Q2,

81% of the programme is on track. The establishing of the new housing complaints team has resulted in the service no longer holding any overdue complaints in and improved satisfaction with the service.

- In Q2, we approved 74 social rent homes and 24 intermediate homes. Key contributing schemes include Unit 1 and Unit 4 Canada Water and Chatelain House. Completions included 58 social rent and 18 intermediate homes on 227-255 Ilderton Road.
- We launched major homelessness and rough sleeping interventions in Q2, including the "Life on the Street" multi-agency forum, which reviews individuals seen rough sleeping 10 or more times over six months to enable coordinated interventions. The Target Priority Group (TPG) focused on 21 entrenched rough sleepers, aiming to transition them into accommodation with tailored support.
- Building on this, the Housing Needs service have now launched co-location of housing advice surgeries in Family Hubs with Children's Services in Q2. Monthly sessions in the Peckham Rye Oak and South Bermondsey Family Hubs are delivering early prevention outcomes, helping our service further streamline the support available.

Areas of continued focus:

- Q2 showed an improvement for the turnaround of major voids which, on average, took 140 days to be re-let within the quarter, compared to 180 days for Q1. However, for minor voids, Q2 showed an average turnaround of 132 days, above 106 days in Q1. Both did not meet the quarterly targets of 120 and 40 days respectively.

12. Goal 2 - A good start in life: Children and young people have a great childhood that builds on a very solid foundation for adult life

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
15	7	5	1	2

Areas of progress:

- In Q2 our youth services team secured a £500,000 Local Youth Transformation Pilot grant, one of only two London boroughs to do so. This funding will be spent on expanding youth engagement, creating a central youth data hub, co-producing a youth commissioning framework and developing a quality assurance framework for youth work.
- Based on most recently available data (end of academic year 2024/25), the number of 16- and 17-year-olds participating in education and training is at 97.3%, an increase from 96% last year and above London averages (95.3%) and national averages (91.2%).
- The refurbishment of two play areas at Nursery Row Park was completed in June, with a celebration event held in July. Work to Peckham Rye Adventure Playground is now on track to start on site in November 2025, with completion anticipated in January 2026. Goose Green and Dulwich Park playground replacement and repairs will also complete by Q4 2025/26.
- At Q2, the estimated year to date percentage of new registrations at our Family Hubs is at 35% of all new births in Southwark, significantly ahead of the quarterly target. This is being delivered through successful partnership promotional activity and enhanced outreach.

Areas of continued focus:

- There was a drop in the attendance at our HAF programmes this summer: 3162 unique children booked places, but only 2,824 attended. Officers are seeking to understand the drop-off in attendance from bookings. This is against a backdrop of uncertainty around DfE funding. Alongside this, we increased our planned leisure centre and youth services offer to include VCS and community-based activities to support as many children as possible.

13. Goal 3 - A safer Southwark: Crime is low and people feel safe

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
16	15	0	0	1

Areas of progress:

- In Q2 we advanced the Community Safety Review, launching integrated multi-agency working in four hotspots. Home Office funding was secured for knife-enabled robbery prevention at Elephant & Castle and the team are planning further area-based interventions. This is supported by strengthened partnerships and increased dedicated police resources in Peckham Town Centre and Elephant & Castle.
- Four area plans across the Aylesbury Estate, Burgess Park, North Walworth and Peckham are delivering integrated multi-agency work, resulting in joint patrols, multiple arrests, enforcement actions, safeguarding assessments, and numerous property closures. Over 3,200 enforcement actions were taken in total across Q1 and Q2. The next phase will strengthen Tasking & Coordination and neighbourhood operations, and introduce a universal warden service.
- During Q2, we delivered four violence against women and girls (VAWG) action days in key hotspot areas: Tooley Street, Peckham, Canada Water and Burgess Park. This is in addition to supporting safety/crime prevention events at university freshers fairs in the north of the borough.
- The Community Harm and Exploitation Hub Operations Group engaged with 97 young people in Q2, including 25 new or re-referred individuals since the start of 2025/26, meeting or exceeding all strategic delivery targets. 87% of young people achieved a positive education, employment, or training outcome within three months, supported by the Hub's integrated model combining mental health input, therapeutic work, mentoring, and wide-ranging practical assistance. Reoffending remained below 3%, with only two young people reoffending in six months.
- Our Southwark Young Advisers engaged over 500 young people in Q2, offering guidance, reassurance, and signposting to positive activities, training opportunities, and local support. 16 young people were referred for safeguarding or specialist support, while shared intelligence, mentoring, and coordinated multi-agency action contributed to Southwark's wider violence reduction efforts.

Areas of continued focus:

- In Q2, Southwark Young Advisers were not able to deliver formal youth-led Stop and Search training sessions with police partners due to wider operational pressures within the Metropolitan Police Service. In response, the Young

Advisors and the VRU have worked proactively with local policing leads to revise content and reschedule sessions for Q3.

- No new Safe Havens were established in the borough in Q2. However, businesses have signed up to the scheme and are awaiting training from the Safer Business Network. We already have 31 venues operating as Safe Havens and we visited 76 prospective venues during our VAWG action days, providing details on how to sign up.

14. Goal 4 - A fair and strong economy: We all benefit from Southwark's economic growth

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
19	15	1	0	3

Areas of progress:

- Excellent progress was made this quarter in supporting residents from priority cohorts (young people, people with disabilities, people with long term health conditions and parents and carers returning to work) into employment. 124 residents were supported in Q2 alone, against an annual target of 150, with 213 residents supported across the two quarters. Delivery of the DWP-funded Connect to Work programme will begin in Q3 and build on this.
- 61 new apprenticeships were started in the borough in Q2, meaning a total of 1,911 apprenticeships have been created for Southwark residents or employers since the start of this administration. We remain on track to reach 2,000 by March 2026.
- We received 17 applications for Round 3 of the Thriving High Streets Fund, with awards to be completed in Q3.
- In Q2 the SC1 Life Sciences Board agreed funding to recruit an SC1 Employment and Skills Officer to work across the partnership and take forward the agreed Employment and Skills Action Plan, and agreed funding for an internship and work experience pilot project for the health and life sciences sector.

Areas of continued focus:

- The number of learners enrolled in adult life skills courses (English for Speakers of Other Languages (ESOL), English functional skills, maths functional skills and digital) through the Adult Learning Service in Q2 decreased to 140. Despite this drop in enrolments due to the summer vacation falling during Q2, we are still meeting the quarterly target of 100 new learners and are above the financial year target.

15. Goal 5 - Staying Well: People across our whole community can have good health and wellbeing

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
13	5	6	0	2

Areas of progress:

- The Canada Water Leisure Centre officially opened in Q2, with 1400 local residents and stakeholders attending our community day on 29 August. All clubs, schools and hirers have been transferred seamlessly between Seven Islands Leisure Centre and Canada Water Leisure Centre, including 2,420 members. There were 6,057 paying members as of 1 September and over 2,200 residents have registered for a free swim and gym membership. This has resulted in over 42,000 visits to the leisure centre since opening in the first three weeks of September.
- Significant progress has been made in Q2 on the recommissioning of the Southwark Wellbeing Hub, with service specifications finalised, increased funding secured (£791,930 annually), and strong market interest from local providers. The new, community-led model will deliver culturally competent mental wellbeing support, integrate with neighbourhood teams and SLAM, and target interventions for diverse communities, promoting equity and inclusion.
- Interim data for Q2 shows 1057 Vital 5 health checks have been completed, supporting people at high risk of ill health including our Black, Asian and ethnic minority communities. The programme remains on track to meet the annual target of 3,000 Vital 5 health checks.
- We continue to expand our support to unpaid carers, with 5588 carers supported in Q2. A new carers service is being shaped by the input of over 400 carers who responded to recent surveys, sharing their preferences for future support and provisions.

16. Goal 6 - A healthy environment: our parks, open spaces and environment is clean, green, and healthy

Total Commitments	On Track	In Progress	At Risk	Delivered
19	15	3	0	1

Areas of progress:

- In Q2, 580 sqm of public realm open space was approved at Chatelain House on Walworth Road. The application has included provision of a publicly accessible “green heart” for residential, commercial, and community uses and a gated pedestrian route linking Walworth Road to Amelia Street.
- Engagement plans for Trees, Ecology, and Community Gardening have progressed, supported by third sector partners. Achievements include over 1,000 volunteers and 1,000 event participants through Ecology contracts, hundreds of community and corporate attendances via Idverde schemes, and targeted workshops and training engaging over 300 individuals, including beekeeping and biodiversity sessions.
- For our School Streets programme, in Q2 cameras were installed at Rye Oak Primary School, and plans are underway to roll out School Streets to most primary schools by year-end. Statutory and informal consultations are progressing at multiple schools, with designs in development for an additional 25, supporting safer, healthier journeys for children across the borough.

- Round 3 of Southwark Green Investment closed in Q2, successfully meeting our target of £1m and exceeding stated commitment. This takes the total raised across three rounds to £2.5m. Round 4 will be launched in Q3 following lead member agreement.

Areas of continued focus:

- 884 cycle hangars have been installed by Q2, slightly behind target. The planned installation of Batch 3 during Q3 should meet the 1,000 target.
- Following confirmation from the Department for Transport that funding for Peckham Rye station square is being paused, the service have been working closely with Network Rail to explore options for bringing the project to a controlled pause, protecting the planning consent and securing minimum station improvements in the short term. We have funded Network Rail to undertake an intervention assessment to explore the feasibility and costs of various options for making Nunhead station fully accessible.

17. Goal 7 - Well-run Council: Leading by example to deliver high-quality, accessible services that meet the needs of all residents

Total Commitments	Delivered	On Track	In Progress	At Risk
13	1	10	2	0

Areas of progress:

- Work continues to strengthen community engagement across the council through practical programmes and partnership working. The Age-Friendly Southwark initiative was agreed by Cabinet in Q2, establishing a cross-council and community-led approach to engagement with older residents.
- At our customer contact centre, within Q2 2025/26, 77% of all contact centre calls were answered within 5 minutes, an improvement by 3% from Q1 2025/26 (74%). However, the percentage of avoidable contacts for Q2 2025/26 is 27%, higher than the limit of 25%. This figure was a marginal improvement from Q1 FY 2024/25 (27.5%), but the above-target figure of repeat calls was due to a large number chasing outstanding repairs.
- For our complaints service, the Resident Experience Plan 2025-2030 was endorsed by Cabinet in Q2. The Plan aims to transform residents' interactions with the Council by ensuring high-quality, consistent, and accessible services, with the REP team establishing engagement and governance to support effective delivery, which is currently on track.

Areas of continued focus:

- Recycling performance for Q2 has slipped to 34.4%. Reported contamination was much higher in Q2 than Q1, which may account for the drop in performance. This will be investigated by the service to understand why, and to identify remedial actions.

18. Development of Corporate Performance Framework and reporting tools.

19. We are committed to strengthening our corporate performance management and reporting, enabling a stronger cross-council focus on measuring the impact and outcomes of Southwark 2030. Work is underway to develop a performance management framework, to support organisational performance management arrangements for the 2026/27 financial year. The principles and key steps to delivering and embedding the framework have been agreed and work is underway to develop a framework document, alongside key reporting products.

Policy framework implications

20. The Southwark 2030 strategy will guide the Council's work over the next six years, acting as the strategic framework that informs our approach to delivery with residents, businesses, community organisations, and partners. The Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan will lay the foundations for delivery over the next year towards our ambitious vision.
21. The Delivery Plan will impact all wards and neighbourhoods in Southwark.

Community, equalities (including socio-economic) and health impacts

Community impact statement

22. Creating Good Lives Together: Our Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan aims to create a positive impact for the communities of Southwark. The commitments in the Delivery Plan are informed by the deep listening and engagement with residents that supported the Southwark 2030 strategy, and rooted in what residents told us they want Southwark to be and feel like in 2030.

Equalities (including socio-economic) impact statement

23. Reducing inequality is a core principle of Southwark 2030 and a major driver of the plan. We are also planning work to increase understanding of the impact of inequality in our borough, gaining a more detailed, evidence-based perspective of the experiences of people who face discrimination and disadvantage in Southwark. This includes the intersectional nature and experience of inequality and discrimination. This work will inform how we tackle systemic inequalities going forward and ensure residents' lived experiences are shaping our work.
24. The Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan contains specific commitments and initiatives that may require their own Equalities Impact and Needs Assessment (EINA). We propose that the equalities implications for these commitments are assessed by the lead officer/s for these commitments at an appropriate time for these projects as details develop on proposed changes and anticipated impact.
25. In the implementation of the Delivery Plan, the council will give due consideration to the Public Sector Equality Duty (PSED) and how we can positively contribute to the advancement of equality.

Health impact statement

26. Our Delivery Plan aims to improve health outcomes and reduce health inequalities across our borough. One of the goals of Southwark 2030 is 'Staying well' which aims to ensure that people across our whole community can have good health and wellbeing. This includes our work to reduce health inequalities, expand access to support for mental and physical health, and improve the wellbeing of people with long term conditions and disabilities, and their carers.
27. There are also cross-cutting commitments which will promote good health and wellbeing; including tackling mould and damp in housing, promoting healthy transport options, improving air quality and supporting children with special educational needs and disabilities.

Climate change implications

28. The Delivery Plan has a range of commitments to prevent and mitigate the impact of climate change, both under our goal to build a healthy environment but also as part of our ambition to be a well-run council. This includes enhancing biodiversity, halving the council's carbon emissions from operational buildings and vehicles, and investing pension funds in zero carbon initiatives. We will also be supporting community energy projects, and developing new ways for local people and businesses to invest in climate action in the borough through Southwark Green Finance.
29. Beyond the commitments directly related to climate action, there are other commitments which will take us further in delivering our net zero ambitions such as the development of greener new homes, delivering town centre improvements, and growing green jobs. Climate change implications will be considered within any specific Cabinet papers on those initiatives.

Resource implications

30. Southwark 2030 was developed in line with the Medium-Term Financial Strategy (MTFS). We will continue to monitor both our Delivery Plan and our financial plans, ensuring that our ambitions set out in Southwark 2030 continue to be realistic and achievable.
31. As work on implementing the Delivery Plan progresses, we will continue to review the status of commitments including whether key decisions are required for delivery.

BACKGROUND DOCUMENTS

Background Papers	Held At	Contact
Delivering Southwark 2030	Strategy and Communities	-

Title of document(s) (Insert hyperlink here)	Link: Agenda for Cabinet on Tuesday 4 February 2025, 11.00am - Southwark Council (see item 8)	Strategy and Communities
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APPENDICES

No.	Title
1	Creating Good Lives Together: Our Southwark 2030 Delivery Plan 2025 - 26

AUDIT TRAIL

Lead Officer	Rhona Cadenhead, Assistant Chief Executive, Strategy and Communities		
Report Author	Moushumi Bhadra, Assistant Director, Strategy and Co-Design		
Version	Draft		
Dated	6 January 2026		
Key Decision?	No		
CONSULTATION WITH OTHER OFFICERS / DIRECTORATES / CABINET MEMBER			
Officer Title		Comments Sought	Comments Included
Assistant Chief Executive, Governance and Assurance			
Strategic Director, Finance			
Cabinet Member			
Date final report sent to Constitutional Team			12 January 2026